The next day I awakened with the first hangover in my life, and the humor of the thing eluded me. When I spent a social day with Lieutenant and Mrs. Kriegman, therefore, I stayed shudderingly away from any liquor.

8

Early on the morning of July 24, 1946, I was on the train to Fort Meade and left Camp Lee forever SVz months after I had seen it for the first time. On that day the second atom bomb was exploded at Bikini, and my fellow specialists were still there. I still felt too good at my own fate to feel guilty about theirs.

Sometime later I received a letter from Ed James, dated June 28. He told me that the letter I had written on April 1 had slowly made its way from the ACS president to the desk of the Secretary of War, and back down again to the admiral in charge of the test.

From the letter, and from still later information I received, it seems that the remaining six specialists were called in and chewed out at the admiral level. They held fast, claimed that the letter had only gone to their professional organization, that they hadn't the slightest idea it would go elsewhere, and managed to put the blame on me. That was the intelligent thing to do since I wasn't there and couldn't be punished. Besides, most of the blame did belong to me.

There was some talk of court-martial but it couldn't possibly have stuck. In the end, although the letter did not get them off the Opera-

tion, it did (Ed told me) result in their getting barracks and better living conditions as a way of quieting them down. They were taken off KP, for instance, so it all did some good.

I did feel guilty at having been out from under when the refuse hit the fan.

9

By dinnertime I was at Fort Meade. I mailed my belongings ahead to Windsor Place, and at 4:30 p.m. on July 26, 1946 (my fourth wedding anniversary, as it happened), I was duly mustered out of the Army with an honorable discharge.

I had been in the Army for eight months and twenty-six days, just about one third of the two-year-hitch I originally assumed would be my lot, and for about one month of that time, all told, I was on furlough in New York. At no